

Information about OSCE stations

Year 5 June 2021

Station	Station title	Details
1	Assessment of drug side effects	Neuro exam for Parkinsonism
2	History and examination of the musculoskeletal system	Back pain history (cauda equina)
3	History taking in a child (from parent)	Headaches – migraine hx
4	Emergency examination of injured patient	A-E assessment pneumothorax
5	Consultation with parents of an unwell child	Counselling parents about putting in a cannula and giving abx for infection
6	History taking in a child (from parent)	Weight loss – eating disorder hx
7	Dermatological/sexual health consultation	Genital rash history and photo description
8	Interpretation and communication of abnormal investigations	Ovarian tumour explanation
9	Mental state examination	Mania/psychosis/depression
10	End of life care consultation	Explain to relative that partner had a stroke and was on life support
11	Assessment of capacity	Capacity assessment in patient wanting to refuse treatment
12	Risk modification and behaviour change	Patient told they need to lose weight before surgery – weight loss counselling

Year 5 July 2022

Station	Station title	Details
1	Examination of the musculoskeletal system	Knee hx, exam and mx to patient (ACL, MCL, meniscus)
2	Assessment of acutely unwell adult using an ABCDE approach	A-E of PV haemorrhage in pregnant woman
3	Medical history taking about a child	Increased WOB in neonate (bronchiolitis) with history and 2 minutes of questions from examiner
4	Communication skills consultation with patient, third party or colleague	Communication with radiologist to request a skeletal survey – conflict resolution/dealing with angry colleague station
5	End of life care consultation	Explaining to a relative that their relative has chosen (with capacity) to refuse further active treatment

		of their disease and that they are therefore end of life. Offering further support and answering questions
6	Consultation with a patient who presents with red flag symptoms	GP consultation and explanation of next steps and 2ww pathway for a patient with bloating (likely ovarian cancer)
7	Consultation with a patient with unexplained symptoms	Loss of consciousness history (?seizure) and explanation of next steps to patient
8	Interpretation and communication of investigations with a patient or relative	Arthritis history and hand examination, then explanation of blood tests (results provided) and treatment
9	Obstetric consultation	History from a pregnant woman with low mood which evolved into a safeguarding consultation when she disclosed domestic violence + offering further support
10	Mental state examination	Psychosis/depression/mania
11	Assessment of cognition	Interpretation of results, history taking and brief neuro exam from a patient with serotonin syndrome and then questions from examiner
12	Ophthalmology consultation	Describing fundoscopy photo to examiner and then behaviour change consultation and management explanation with a patient with hypertension or diabetes (hypertensive retinopathy or diabetic retinopathy)

Year 5 November 2022

Station	Station title	Details
1	Examination of the musculoskeletal system	Shoulder hx, exam and management – rotator cuff tear
2	Medical history taking about a child	Asthma hx, explanation of diagnosis and management with parent
3	Examination of the neurological system	Lower limb neurological exam and questions about ddx from findings
4	Sexual health consultation	Post-coital bleeding history in a patient who had never had a smear. ?STI or cervical cancer.

		Explanation of both options and next steps to investigate and follow up both
5	Psychiatric history taking about a child	Weight loss history from parent – eating disorder with parent who is convinced there is an organic cause
6	Risk assessment in a mental health consultation	Risk assessment of suicidal patient and presentation of assessment and discussion of next steps with the examiner
7	Musculoskeletal system consultation	Cauda equina history and management consultation with patient
8	Assessment of acutely unwell adult using an ABCDE approach	Standard tension pneumothorax A-E including explanation of chest drain insertion
9	Communication skills consultation with a patient, third party or colleague	Explanation of need for antibiotics to an antivax parent of a child with meningitis
10	Interpretation and communication of abnormal investigations	Explanation of pelvic ultrasound results in a patient with suspected uterine cancer. Breaking bad news and discussion of next steps (hysteroscopy)
11	Mental state examination	Mania in a pregnant patient
12	End of life care consultation	Explaining to a relative that their partner has had a brainstem stroke, is in intensive care and is end of life.

Year 5 June 2023

Station	Station title	Details
1	A&E - anaphylaxis	Straightforward station, A-E assessment of patient having a reaction to flucloxacillin that was given to them in hospital.
2	Gynae – endometriosis/sexual abuse?	Gynae history, dyspareunia.
3	Low mood history & aetiological factors	Elderly man with low mood and physical illness and loss of a loved one. Describing aetiological factors – 4Ps.
4	Cerebellar examination	Patient had no signs. Normal examination. Questions about causes of unsteadiness.
5	Rheum/Derm – psoriatic arthritis	Describe images of nail psoriasis and speak to patient about management.
6	Otitis media + management	Look at image of inner ear, explain to parent what otitis media is and management.
7	MSK consultation	Describe X-ray of the knee, OA of the knee and management – lifestyle and surgical options.
8	Emergency PV bleeding	Difficult station, A-E assessment. Not sure what was going on.
9	Mental state examination	MSE for a patient who is suicidal.
10	GP motivational interviewing	Checkup with patient who has hypertension, smokes, diabetes and encouraging ways to manage these/continue managing them.
11	End of life consultation	For a patient with MND – who makes decisions at end of life, any symptoms and how they can be managed.
12	Breath holding spell	Parent presents to A&E with child after having a seizure. Breath-holding spell.

Year 5 Resit 2023

Station	Station title	Details
1	Psych risk assessment low mood	
2	Neuro MND talk to relative	
3	ORTEM A-E pneumothorax	
4	Paeds: Septic child, explain cannulation	
5	WRH: Vaginal rash	
6	GP: Lifestyle advice weight loss PCOS	
7	Psych: Capacity assessment	
8	Neuro: Parkinson exam	
9	ORTEM: History + shoulder exam (Frozen shoulder)	
10	Paeds: History of febrile convulsion	
11	WRH: Explain positive HPV result to patient and explain referral to colposcopy	
12	GP: back pain red flags (diagnosis: cauda equina)	

Year 5 June 2024

Station	Station title	Details
1	GP: Consultation on risk factors in diabetic	Pretty straightforward. Annual DM review results, explain and give lifestyle advice/med advice to patient (esp. on DM, HTN, cholesterol, lifestyle).
2	MSK/Neuro: Low back pain history + exam	Nightmare. Asked to take history, perform back exam + lower limb neuro exam in the same station, and explain differentials to patient.
3	WRH: Baby in breech position Hx/comms	Comms skill/history – take a focused history and explain to pregnant lady (36w) what breech is, and discuss delivery.
4	Paeds: PR bleeding history	Simple history from mum about 4yo son with fresh bleeding. Likely fissure from constipation.
5	Neuro/ORTEM: CN exam/A-E	Absolute nightmare. Told to perform a GCS assessment, and assessment of the cranial nerve

		reflexes on a mannequin (as well as comment on afferent/efferent limbs). Not mentioned on sheet, but it was also an A-E station.
6	Psych: Chest pain history	Straightforward Hx of patient in ED who had panic attack, but thought it was a heart attack.
7	GP: Asthma management	Interpret investigation results and explain diagnosis/management of asthma to patient. Explain inhaler + spacer technique.
8	A-E station – sepsis	Standard A-E for patient with signs of sepsis secondary to a UTI and pyelonephritis.
9	Gynae Hx – stress incontinence	ICE was important here, reassure of it being common and discuss mental health support.
10	Comms station with mother of baby in ED	Bit weird. History + comms station for 1d old child w/blue spell. Mum wants to go home, we want to admit kid. Risk assessment/safeguarding component.
11	Neuro - History of dizziness (BPPV)	Straightforward history of patient with dizziness – BPPV.
12	Psych – MSE of patient w/psychosis	Straightforward MSE of pt w/persecutory delusions.

Year 5 June 2025

Station	Station title	Details
1	Neuro – Speech and language exam	Asked to assess speech and language and ‘assess the relevant cranial nerves’ in a patient – was a normal actor with no signs though. Had to give differentials for causes of dysphasia at the end.
2	Paeds – non-blanching rash (ITP)	Worried parent giving a history of non-blanching rash in their child, asked if it was meningitis. Everything in history was normal. Given blood results at the end (showed isolated low platelets) and asked to give differentials (most likely ITP).

3	GP – Fatigue history	Straightforward history of woman with fatigue, bloating and weight loss. Had to give differentials and further investigations (cannot miss cancer).
4	WRH/ORTEM – PPH A-E	Straightforward PPH A-E. Asked at the end what the 4 Ts of PPH causes are and how to manage them.
5	Psych – Alcohol/anxiety history	Bit of a weird history – patient seen in A&E with an injured wrist yesterday and asked to come in again today, you have to discuss their alcohol use/anxiety with them.
6	ORTEM – Ankle history + image/XR explanation + management	Had to take history of ankle fracture, then explain what you saw in a picture of an ankle (mainly pixelated bruises) and then explain the XR to the patient. Had to explain management (Weber A fracture – boot and weight bearing).
7	Psych – Lithium counselling	Had to talk to a worried parent about his (adult) daughter who started lithium recently. Lots of reassurance and comms.
8	WRH – Emergency contraception counselling	History and counselling for a woman who recently had unprotected sex and wanted a morning-after pill. I think ulipristal acetate was the correct option. Asked at the end about the mechanism of action of ulipristal acetate and rules for contraception beforehand (i.e. no progestogen 7d before or 5d after).
9	Paeds – Angry parent	Parent of a child with croup who was angry that she had not been told anything. You have to tell her the child needs to be moved to paed's ICU. Likely mostly comms. Asked at the end 'Who else do you want to speak to?' – odd question, probably the consultant and handover to paed's ICU??

10	Neuro – Headache and loss of vision	Bit of a weird history for a woman who got an occipital headache and lost vision 2 days ago. Went to Specsavers and got a visual field test – you then had to interpret the visual field results – showed homonymous hemianopia. Asked to give differentials and management at the end – likely posterior stroke. Needs urgent neuroimaging.
11	GP – CKD and lifestyle history + management	Given table of results in instructions. Had most GP conditions you can think of – BP controlled with drugs, BMI 30, new raised urea/creatinine. Had to explain to patient they had CKD stage 3 and propose management. Some time for lifestyle suggestions e.g. smoking cessation, weight loss.
12	ORTEM – A-E Insulin overdose	Told in instructions that patient has overdosed on their insulin. Started A-E, patient initially confused. Then patient quickly lost consciousness and you had to do a proper A-E with management. Glucose dose was nicely given in a sheet of Toxbase guidelines.